

Ἡρόφιλος ὁ Χαλκηδόνιος

Herophilus the Anatomist on Nourishment and the Body

eul_aid: ifm

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine \(frg\)](#)

Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)

Format: Λόγος [Oration](#)

Herophilus was a Greek physician and anatomist born in Chalcedon. He worked in Alexandria during the early 3rd century BCE under the patronage of the Ptolemies, where the unique permission for human dissection enabled his pioneering work. A student of Praxagoras of Cos, he established his own influential medical school and conducted systematic anatomical investigations, including dissections and possibly vivisections, which allowed for unprecedented direct observation.

His major, now lost, works include *On Anatomy*, detailing his discoveries, and specialized treatises such as *On the Eyes*, *Midwifery*, and *On Pulses*, in which he developed pulse theory. Other lost texts are *Against Common Opinions* and *A Handbook for Midwives*.

Herophilus is a foundational figure in the history of medicine. His empirical approach led to major discoveries, including identifying the brain as the nervous system's center, describing organs like the liver and pancreas, and naming the duodenum. His work on the pulse and his anatomical findings formed the core of the Alexandrian medical school and profoundly influenced later thinkers like Galen.

Works (2)

- Πῶς ὀφείλει διαιτᾶσθαι ἄνθρωπος ἐφ' ἐκάστῳ μηνί · [How a Man Ought to Live Each Month](#) · 11 passages
- Περὶ μεθόδου τροφῆς · [On the Method of Nourishment](#) · 60 passages